

To,
The Chief Engineer (Legal)
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Subject: Second supplementary to my comments of 16 September 2026, as supplemented on 22 September 2026, on the draft Central Electricity Authority (Technical Standards for Construction of Electric Plants and Electric Lines) 2nd Amendment, Regulations, 2026 — F. No. CEA-TH-17/1/2021-TETD Division, dated 3 September 2026 — the metering question traced through the Authority's own instruments

Sir / Madam,

1. My comment 2 of 16 September 2026 asked that the final regulations state at what point energy discharged from the storage made compulsory by the proposed Regulation 106B(20) is deemed generated, and specify the metering arrangement required to establish it. My supplementary note of 22 September 2026 added the record of Tamil Nadu and submitted that this was the more urgent of my two comments, because it is the one the Authority can settle itself. This note does not repeat either. It records where the question leads when it is followed through the instruments that would answer it.

Where the question is sent

2. The draft Central Electricity Authority (Technical Standards for Connectivity to the Grid) Regulations, 2026, published for comment on 31 July 2026, is the instrument that sets the technical requirements for a co-located battery. It defines a “Co-located generating station” as two or more generating stations, including energy storage systems, that are operated and controlled as a separate facility and are connected behind a single Point of Interconnection (Regulation 2(xi)). The Authority has therefore recognised the arrangement.

3. On metering, that draft provides, at Regulation 205, that metering shall be provided as specified in the Central Electricity Authority (Installation and Operation of Meters) Regulations in force. It settles nothing itself. Regulation 18 of the same draft provides that all its provisions shall be complied with and met by the facility at the PoI — that is, compliance is assessed at the single point behind which, on the Authority's own definition, two facilities may sit.

4. The Meters Regulations in force are the Central Electricity Authority (Installation and Operation of Meters) Regulations, 2006, as last amended by the Amendment Regulations of 1 April 2026 and corrected on 10 April 2026. In those Regulations:

(a) “Interface Meter” is defined as a meter used for accounting and billing of electricity, connected at the point of interconnection between the electrical systems of a generating company, a licensee and consumers (Regulation 2(1)(n)). The definition contemplates a point between two parties, not two facilities of the same party behind one point.

(b) The Table under Regulation 7 fixes the location of main, check and standby meters by stage: generating station, transmission and distribution system, inter-connecting transformer, and consumer permitted open access. There is no entry for an energy storage system, and none for a co-located facility.

(c) The amendment of 1 April 2026 substituted the entries at Sl. Nos. 4 and 5 of that Table, dealing with consumers permitted open access above and not exceeding 650 V, and substituted clause (b) of Regulation 4(1) on smart meters. It did not touch storage.

(d) The words “energy storage”, “storage system” and “battery” do not appear anywhere in the Regulations in that sense. The only occurrences of “storage” are in respect of the data storage capacity of a meter.

5. So the Connectivity Standards send the metering question to the Meters Regulations, and the Meters Regulations do not contain it. There is no instrument of the Authority that states how the charging and the discharging of a co-located battery are to be separately measured, or at which hour the discharge is deemed generated.

Why this is now more pressing than it was on 16 September

6. On 21 September 2026, after my earlier comments, the Central Electricity Regulatory Commission published for comment the draft CERC (Indian Electricity Grid Code) (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026 (No. L-1/265/2022/CERC), with comments open to 21 October 2026. That draft proposes to bring a Battery Energy Storage System of 10 MW and above connected at 33 kV and above into the primary frequency response framework of Table 4 under Regulation 30(10), and to require an Energy Storage System of 25 MW and above to enable automatic operation from the appropriate load despatch centre under Regulation 24(2). At paragraph 12.8 of its Explanatory Memorandum, the Commission records that the primary response capability for these sources “shall be as per the CEA Technical Standards for Connectivity”. The Commission's memorandum also carries, at paragraph 12.3, the National Load Despatch Centre's note that a comprehensive revision of the CEA Technical Standards is presently under drafting.

7. The central framework is therefore being built on the Authority's standards while those standards are in draft, and the metering they point to has not been revised for storage since 2006. Three instruments now address the same battery — the proposed Regulation 106B(20), which makes it compulsory; the draft Connectivity Standards, which set its technical requirements; and the draft Grid Code amendment, which gives it a frequency-response obligation — and in none of them is it said how its energy is to be measured or at which hour its discharge is deemed generated.

8. I note that the comment period on the draft Connectivity Standards closed on 2 September 2026, before I had examined the question in this form. I make no submission on that draft. I record it because the present draft, on which comments remain open, is the instrument that creates the asset whose measurement the other instruments leave unsettled.

What I respectfully suggest

9. That the final regulations, in the proviso to Regulation 106B(20) or by a provision read with it, state expressly (a) at which hour energy discharged from the mandated storage is deemed generated for the purposes of scheduling, metering and energy accounting, and (b) that the charging and the discharging of the mandated storage shall be separately metered, with the location of the meters specified, notwithstanding that the storage sits behind a single Point of Interconnection with the plant it serves.

10. In the alternative, that the Authority record in the final regulations, or in the statement accompanying them, that the metering arrangement for co-located storage will be addressed in the revision of the Installation and Operation of Meters Regulations, with an indication of when. A developer taking a financing decision for a plant to be commissioned after 1 July 2027 can work with a stated timetable. It cannot work with a reference that leads nowhere.

11. The instruments cited are listed below. I would be glad to provide copies if that is of use to the Authority.

Yours faithfully,

D. S. Nikam

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Annex — instruments cited

Central Electricity Authority

- Draft CEA (Technical Standards for Construction of Electric Plants and Electric Lines) 2nd Amendment, Regulations, 2026 — F. No. CEA-TH-17/1/2021-TETD Division, dt 03.09.2026 — proposed Regulation 106B(20) and its first proviso.
- Draft CEA (Technical Standards for Connectivity to the Grid) Regulations, 2026 — public notice dt 31.07.2026, comments closed 02.09.2026 — Regulations 2(xi), 18, 89 and Table 4, 205.
- CEA (Installation and Operation of Meters) Regulations, 2006 — Notification No. 502/70/CEA/DP&D dt 22.03.2006 — Regulation 2(1)(n); Regulation 7(1)(a) and the Table thereunder.
- CEA (Installation and Operation of Meters) Amendment Regulations, 2026 — F. No. 1/12/CEA/DPM/Regulations/2025 dt 01.04.2026, Gazette No. 233 — amendments to Regulation 4(1)(b) and to Sl. Nos. 4 and 5 of Table-1 under Regulation 7(1)(a); Corrigendum dt 10.04.2026, Gazette No. 260.

Central Electricity Regulatory Commission

- Draft CERC (Indian Electricity Grid Code) (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026 — No. L-1/265/2022/CERC dt 21.09.2026, comments open to 21.10.2026 — Explanatory Memorandum paras 9.3, 9.4, 12.3, 12.8; proposed amendments to Regulations 24(2) and 30(10).